



▲ **Timetables of private railway companies** showcased a range of graphic styles and details. Some like the GIPR promised improvements in "post-war" services, while others, such as the BB&CI, displayed sophisticated design aesthetics.

The early timetables published by railway companies were quite basic, often limited to the services provided by them. So, it fell to private publishers, such as Britain's Thomas Cook and George Bradshaw, to compile and sell the more comprehensive ones. The latter, Bradshaw, was so popular that his name became synonymous with rail timetables.

India's "Newman's Indian Bradshaw" began publishing from 1868 and did much more than tell arrival and departure times. Many provided a fascinating insight into the social conditions of the time, whether it was